ASAGIRI ISLES · BALANCE NOTES

How the isles were balanced

I ran the world through an offline simulator: 200 games of 60 turns and 600 creator builds put through duels, then marked what felt right and what didn't. These are the numbers behind the changes, for players who want to know how a fight, a purse or a tradition is tuned, and for creators who want the method.

Build d77cbe300525 · 2026-10-28 · reports batch-20261028-215743.json, builds-20261028-232004.json

Fights: rank and level gap

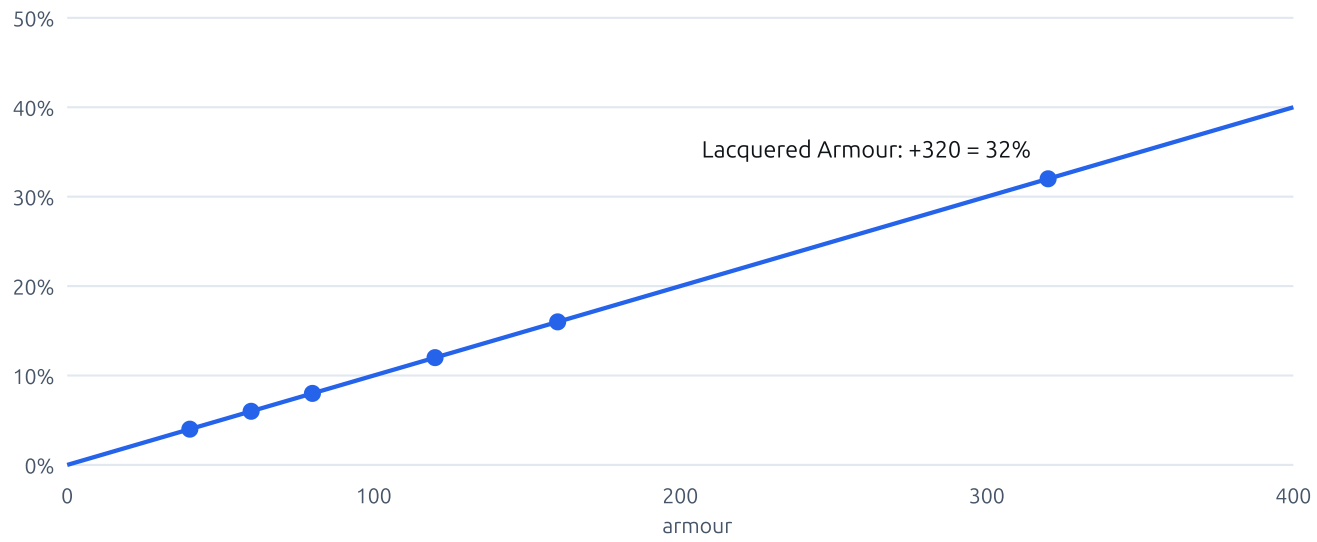
A foe's rank and how far it stands above you decide most of a fight. Each square is every simulated fight of that kind: how often the player went down, how often they won, and how many fights the number rests on. Grey squares had too few fights to say.

	-5 or lower	-4..-1	even	+1..+4	+5 or higher
weak	2 fights	1 fights	0 fights	**downed 0%** won 86% · 7	4 fights
average	**downed 0%** won 82% · 11	2 fights	**downed 0%** won 100% · 5	**downed 0%** won 56% · 9	**downed 55%** won 9% · 22
strong	**downed 0%** won 60% · 5	1 fights	0 fights	**downed 67%** won 33% · 6	**downed 54%** won 20% · 41
elite	0 fights	3 fights	0 fights	**downed 20%** won 60% · 5	**downed 75%** won 3% · 173
boss	0 fights	0 fights	0 fights	0 fights	**downed 60%** won 0% · 5

Downed share by foe rank (rows) and the foe's level minus yours (columns). Darker is deadlier. Bosses far above you can be escaped: flee or break away mid-fight and every foe in it is left behind.

Armour

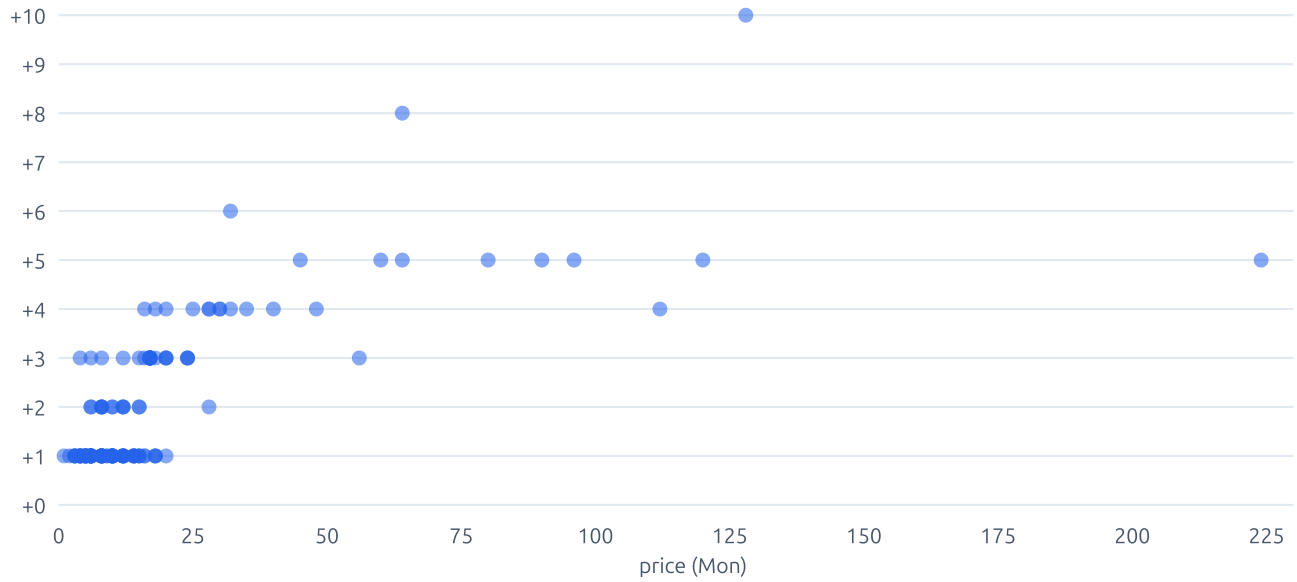
Every point of armour takes 0.1% off the damage you take, up to 90%. A full set of good garb now takes about a third off a blow: the best piece sold, Lacquered Armour, gives +320 for 12 Mon.



Damage cut against armour; each dot is a priced armour value in the world's shops.

Gear: price and bonus

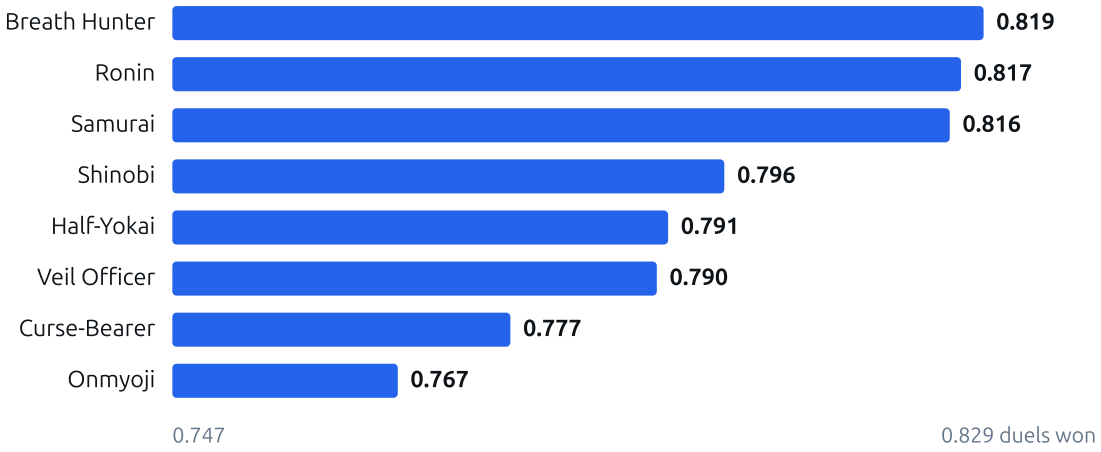
Every price I wrote stands (a pearl earring can cost more than a headband for the same +1: that is the isles' taste). Where a dearer piece did no more than a cheap one in its slot, it gained a second bonus that fits it, so nothing on a shelf is beaten outright: 0 items are dominated now, 0 kit items unpriced.



Each dot is one priced piece of gear: its price against its skill, attribute and damage bonuses added up (armour is charted above).

The eight traditions

Every creator build was put through the same duels: three levels, every foe rank, four level gaps. A tradition's score is the share of those duels its builds won. The Soul traditions start with 10 more Health than before, because a point of Soul buys less in a straight fight than a point of Health.



Mean duel win share of the builds that picked each tradition. The duels do not model what the techniques do in a fight (below), only their roll bonus.

What each tradition's techniques do in a fight

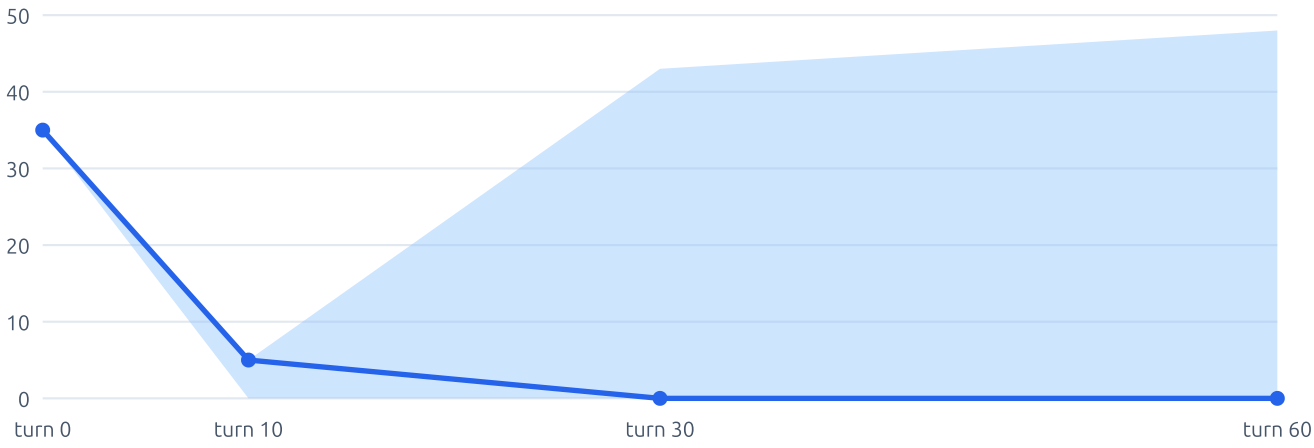
Tradition	Technique	In a fight
Shinobi	**Borrowed Face**	In a fight the foes lose you: your blow next turn is an ambush for 10 more damage to each.
Shinobi	**Cast-Off Husk**	In a fight the hit is undone: 10 Health back, and you reappear a few paces off.
Samurai	**Drawn Edge**	In a fight the draw is the strike: 15 damage at once to every foe in the fight.
Samurai	**Name Spoken**	In a fight the named foe hesitates and loses its next action.
Ronin	**Road-Worn Guard**	In a fight the old soldier's second wind: 12 Health back.
Veil Officer	**Ferryman's Rite**	In a fight the foes are driven back across the Veil, and the fight ends.
Half-Yokai	**The Other Side Shows**	In a fight the blood's strength: 12 damage to every foe in the fight, and everyone sees what you are.
Onmyoji	**Paper Servant**	In a fight the paper soldier strikes with you: 8 damage to every foe in the fight.
Onmyoji	**Barrier of Five Seals**	In a fight the blows break on the seals: 15 Health back.
Breath Hunter	**First Breath Form**	In a fight one move faster than anything human: 12 damage at once to every foe in the fight.
Breath Hunter	**Sun-Steel Cut**	In a fight the wound stays: 5 damage a turn for 3 turns to every foe in the fight.
Curse-Bearer	**Pass It On**	In a fight the burden moves: you lose 5 Health on balance and everyone else in the party gains 15.

Curse-Bearer	**Grudge Given Shape**	In a fight the grudge bites: 10 damage to every foe in the fight, and their blows weaken.
Ronin	**Sell the Sword**	Not a fight technique: unchanged.
Veil Officer	**Unseen Among the Living**	Not a fight technique: unchanged.
Half-Yokai	**Welcome at the Edge**	Not a fight technique: unchanged.

A technique's effect lands only for its own tradition, off its cooldown, and when its Soul can be paid.

Money

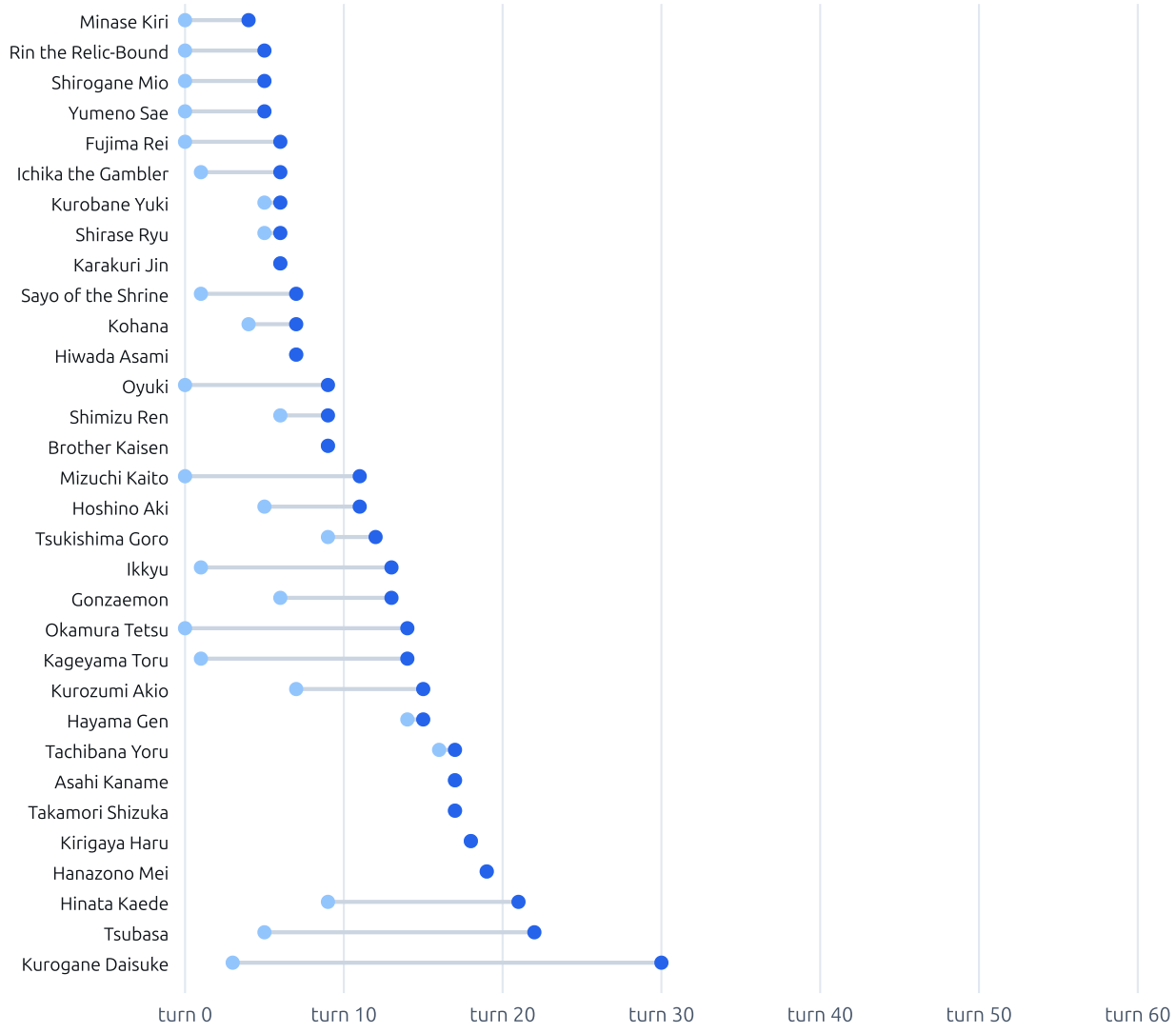
Mon is scarce on purpose. Every character starts with 35, enough for a kit and a fare. Over a 60-turn run the narrator pays about 29.8 Mon and asks about 12 for fares, food and favours (2.5x), and half the runs come up short of a charge at least once (56%).



Mon held across the simulated runs: the line is the median run, the band the middle 80%.

Pace

Most experience comes from quests and story beats, little from fighting, so wandering and killing does not level you. A premade reaches level 10 around turn 5 and level 20 around turn 11 (medians).



Median turn each premade first reached level 10 (light) and level 20 (dark).

For creators: the method

The simulator plays the world's own JSON turn by turn with Voyage's trigger rules, a seeded stand-in narrator, and combat from the documented formulas. Numbers no document settles are named assumptions, each with its source (below); live play on a private copy of the world settles what the simulator cannot.

My marks: before and now

	Mark	Before	Now	What was done
change	**Too easy** f-average-even	average NPC at the player's level: 88% won, 19% health lost	100% won, 25% health lost	Every NPC hits harder for its rank (+30%; weak and average +40% and 1.3x Health), so an even fight costs something.
change	**Too easy** f-weak-up	weak NPCs above the player: 83-100% won	86% won (+1..+4)	Weak NPCs carry the same +40% damage and 1.3x Health edge.
change	**Too hard** f-boss-5	boss +5: 80% downed, 0% won	60% downed; the run-away move is in	Bosses keep their strength; you can now run: flee mid-fight and every foe in it is left behind (asg_run_away).
change	**Too loose** e-flow	narrator pays +27.5, charges -6.4 Mon per 60 turns	pays 29.8, asks 12 Mon a run (2.5x)	Measured right (per currency, against what the narrator asks) pay is 2.3x the asks, on your target: no world change, a sim fix.
change	**Armour should count more** e-armour	+80 armour = 8% less damage taken	best garb +320 armour = 32% less damage	Every armour value x4: a full set of good garb takes about a third off a blow.
change	**Fix them** e-dominated	25 items another item beats outright	0 dominated	Bonus follows price: every price kept, the dearer item in a slot gains a fitting second skill.
change	**Price them** e-unpriced	22 gear items with bonuses and no price	0 unpriced gear	Kit items priced from their slot's curve; two heirlooms stay found-only.
change	**Too samey** b-spread	creator builds 0.642-0.735 (p10-p90)	0.755-0.830 (p10-p90)	Read as builds PLAYING alike: the tradition techniques now do something in a fight (damage, Health back, a bleed, an ambush, sending foes off).
change	**Too uneven** b-traditions	Breath Hunter 0.727 .. Onmyoji 0.655	Breath Hunter 0.819 .. Onmyoji 0.767	The five Soul traditions carry +10 Health on top of their Soul (a Soul point buys less in a fight).
change	**Too uneven** b-premades	premades 0.63-0.79	0.748-0.873	Left as written, at your call; they rose with their traditions.
hold	**feels right** f-average-up	43%	56% won	
hold	**feels right** f-elite-up	80%	60% won	
hold	**feels right** f-average-5	58%	55% downed	

hold	**feels right** f-strong-5	56%	54% downed	
hold	**feels right** f-elite-5	82%	75% downed	refer to boss regarding runaway
hold	**feels right** f-gap	81%	81%	
hold	**feels right** p-l10	turn 2.5	turn 5	
hold	**feels right** p-l20	turn 11	turn 11	
hold	**feels right** p-l30	turn 2	2	
hold	**feels right** p-xp	57% / 41% / 2%	58% / 41% / 2%	prevents murder hobos
hold	**feels right** e-kit	turn 5	5 Mon	
hold	**feels right** e-short	51%	56%	
hold	**feels right** e-talisman	+60% outgoing damage	unchanged	yeah if you pump damage you take more hits
hold	**feels right** e-adherence	9 of 17	unchanged	you dont really get a lot of mon by comparison to other games so slightly cheaper is ok

What live games proved

- A technique's typed damage lands on the foe: Paper Servant took a foe 278 to 214, the narrated hit 56 plus the technique's 8.
- A companion travelling with you is not struck by a technique's damage; a narrator-made summon in the scene can be.
- A technique's own cooldown blocks a second typed use; Barrier of Five Seals' Health and Sun-Steel Cut's bleed land as written.
- The narrator pays about 2.2x what it charges in recorded Asagiri games, matching the simulator's 2.3x.

Assumptions

Assumption	Value	Source
conditions_read_phase_start_storage	true	R46-R47 (a typed write-boolean set in a pass is read by conditions from the NEXT turn) vs R17 (triggers see earlier writes in the same phase); parity settles it
planning_script_starts	12	R46-R47 (planning held ~8 starts worst, 12-16 better)
state_script_starts	12	R46-R47 (no state-phase measurement: planning's numbers)
script_timeout_ms	500	triggers doc: 500 ms shared per phase

script_trigger_delete_lands	false	R48 / R81: a `delete triggers[...]` never landed live
ai_checks_per_turn	15	triggers doc Size Limits: ~15 per turn
ai_checks_per_active_quest	5	triggers doc Size Limits: +5 per active quest
objectives_start_hidden	true	unknown (plan Task 2 ruling)
skills_start_at_zero	true	unknown
text_contains_case_sensitive	true	unknown
resource_clamped_to_max	true	unknown
level_up_resource_rule	by_gain	OQ#13 open; live DEV canaries (gainPerLevel 0) stay 0 after a level set, so not 'fill' for those
narrator_move_before_state_phase	true	unknown: R10 settles a planning trigger's move only; parity measures the narrator's
ai_budget_file_order	true	unknown (OQ#6: the order AI checks spend the budget in)
satisfying_players_intersection	true	unknown: the doc names the satisfying player(s), not how several player conditions combine
quest_accept_completes_progressed	true	unknown: Q says hidden/planned quests accumulate progress silently, not what accept then does
premade_start_full	true	unknown: resourceSettings.md gives initialValue for a NEW (level 1) character only
premade_xp_at_level	true	unknown: whether a premade above level 1 starts with its level's XP or with 0
location_move_area	first	triggers doc: party-location cascades the area; which one is unknown: the first authored
quest_triggers_after_triggers	true	unknown
success_level_weights	{"critical failure": 3, "failure": 12, "	unknown until sim_parity calibrates it
attack_words	["attack", "strike", "slash", "stab", "h	unknown: when Voyage resolves an action as combat is the narrator's call (batch policy)
roll_spread	cap	skillSettings.md caps a roll's contribution at maxSkillSuccessLevel; its distribution is unknown (uniform assumed)
player_base_damage	10	unknown: npcs.md gives +2.5 per level, not the level-1 base
npc_base_damage	8	unknown: npcs.md gives +2.0 per level, not the base
band_damage_factor	{"critical failure": 0.0, "failure": 0.0	unknown until sim_calibrate fits the recorded hits
combat_xp_scaling	flat	unknown: combatSettings.md calls baseCombatXP a base, not how NPC level or tier scales it
combat_xp_split	equal	unknown: combatSettings.md gives the base, not the split
narrator_xp_chance	0.133	calibrated: 3737 turns

narrator_xp_size	177	recordings 2026-10-27: median 177, p10 153, p90 192 over 66 awards
fight_to_finish	true	batch policy: an engaged player keeps attacking, so a fight's length and cost are measured whole
max_fight_turns	20	batch policy: a fight longer than this counts as unfinished
attack_skill_types	["combat", "magic"]	batch policy: the committed player attacks with its best combat or magic skill (an Onmyoji's art, not a sword it never trained); the narrator picks the skill li
attack_move_rule	attack	abilities.md: the bonus reaches the relevant check; 'attack' = the move's text names an attack skill or reads as an attack (Asagiri: 'Improves the next Blade ac
ability_use	best_ready	batch policy: live the player picks; the committed player uses its best ready move on an attack
bench_levels	[1, 10, 20]	build bench grid (design 2026-10-28, phase 3b)
bench_gaps	[0, 3, 6, 9]	build bench grid: NPC level = player level + gap; Asagiri 2026-10-28: elite wins 1.0/0.95/0.40/0.04 at +0/+4/+6/+8, so +-2 told no build apart
bench_reps	20	build bench grid: duels per cell
build_band	0.1	his creator method: a measured band; a pick whose builds win this much more or less than its tab's median
equip_policy	best	batch policy: live the player equips by hand; the committed player wears the best held gear
gear_score_weights	{"damage": 10, "armor": 0.1, "resource":	batch policy: 1 damage point (+10%) ~ 100 armor (10%) ~ 100 resource max ~ 10 skill points
kit_at_start	true	batch policy; Asagiri's outfitter section: the 35-Mon start buys one garb and one mask
kit_reserve	0.15	batch policy; Asagiri's outfitter section: garb and mask 'with a coach fare left over'
shop_chance	0.05	unknown (batch policy: a buy roll per turn)
narrator_income_chance	0.009	calibrated: 1476 turns of Mon
narrator_income_size	1.38	calibrated: 13 lines of Mon
narrator_spend_chance	0.041	calibrated: 1476 turns of Mon
narrator_spend_size	0.13	calibrated: 61 lines of Mon
move_chance	0.2	unknown (batch policy)
accept_chance	0.5	unknown (batch policy: the player's Accept click per turn)